

BALFOUR IS AROUSED BY TALK OF AN ALLIANCE

WASHINGTON, April 25.—Condemnation of "certain doubting critics who think France and Great Britain have come here to inveigle the United States into entangling alliances with European forces," was voiced by British Foreign Secretary Arthur J. Balfour in a public statement here today.

The British foreign secretary, on the eve of the greatest world war council, outlined a brief declaration of motives and principles on behalf of our European allies.

"There could be no rumor with less foundation than the one I have just outlined," he said. His fist clenched and his jaw set, and he looked squarely in the eyes of his listeners as he continued: "And were it true there could be no more fallacious policy."

"No Small Interest"

"I wish to assure the people of this great nation that the assistance we are going to get from the United States is based on no such shallow consideration."

Then turning abruptly to America's part in the war Balfour said:

"You have been watching this blood-stained drama from afar. Each month the conviction in your minds has grown that no small or petty interests are involved."

"You realize that this is not a quarrel for so many square miles of territory."

"You know thoroughly well that the liberties of mankind alone are animating the allied cause."

"Therefore you have joined in the great contest."

"We know you will throw all your forces of invention, production and main power into the balance."

"Nothing can turn you from it."

No Separate Peace.

Taking a step nearer his auditors, the British envoy, his tall, frock-coated slender form tense, spoke quietly and earnestly of his feelings toward America and the feeling he has sensed in America toward the allied cause.

"You will see the war through. If there is any certainty in human affairs, that is certain."

GERMANS MAKE A BLOODY SACRIFICE TO STOP ONRUSH

LONDON, April 24.—What is apparently the bitterest fighting of the present Anglo-French offensive is raging today along the Wotan line, the hastily organized position east of Arras, to which the Germans retired when the northern end of the Hindenburg line was turned by General Haig. The Germans are putting forth a supreme effort to hold this vital portion of their defenses, the crumbling of which would expose Douai and Cambrai and bring into prospect another great retreat.

The British have driven two wedges into the German positions, forming sharp salients in the region of the Scarpe river and north of the Bapaume-Cambrai road. The head of the first salient has been thrust within four miles of Vitry, the most important point on the Wotan line, but the tenacity and power with which the Germans are fighting leaves the issue for a time in doubt.

The little news that trickles across the German frontier indicates that the authorities have gained the upper hand in the strike situation by the drastic method of militarizing the munition industry and forcing strike leaders into the fighting ranks.

The only news from Austria in some days is to the effect that the pan-German leaders have emerged as victors in the struggle for control of the government.

INDIAN HANGED AT FORT WRIGHT

SPOKANE, April 19.—Edward Mayberry, a half-breed Indian, was hanged at Fort George Wright today by the United States Marshal. He was convicted in the United States district court of killing Alice Vivian, an Indian woman on the Colville reservation.

Germans Will Blow Up Allies Hospital Ships

PARIS, April 25.—"Contrary to all the rules of international law and humanity," says an official note, "the Germans have announced that they will torpedo all hospital ships without warning. Under these conditions the French government gives notice that German prisoners will be embarked on these vessels."

JAPANESE PUT FOOT DOWN AGAINST CHINA DECLARING HOSTILITIES

TOKIO, April 25.—Officials of the Japanese government have practically admitted that Japan's refusal to agree to China's conditions stands in the way of a declaration of war by China against Germany.

It is known that China informed the allied diplomats at Peking of three conditions on which she would join the allies by declaring war against Germany. These proposals were made on March 14, when the break Germany was announced.

They were that the allied powers give their consent to raising the maritime customs tariff of China, fixed by international agreement at 3 1/2 per cent ad valorem, to 5 per cent, that the powers permit China to postpone for a period of years the payment of the Boxer indemnity and that the powers agree to the cancellation of the agreement which bars Chinese soldiers from entering foreign concessions at Tien Tsin.

It is to the first of these conditions that Japan is especially opposed. Japan's trade in textiles with China is one of the bulwarks of her overseas commerce and it is claimed by the Japanese weavers that an increase in China's tariff rate will work havoc to Japanese trade.

Army Stops Work to Gaze at Master Airmen as They Do Battle Among Clouds

WITH THE BRITISH ARMIES AFIELD, April 25.—Frightful losses were inflicted on German troops vainly counter-attacking at Gavrelle today.

From a range of 300 yards, almost point-blank, British artillery poured concentrated fire upon the Germans' massed ranks.

The attacking forces were literally and completely cut to pieces.

South of the Scarpe the British are advancing steadily.

North of the river, however, the battle today was in the standstill stage, the most desperate fighting of the war featuring violent efforts by both sides to gain.

Master Airmen

Again today the skies, where 40 enemy planes were brought down yesterday, were battlefields for scores of fights. Literally hundreds of machines twisted and turned and ducked and jumped in battle or in scouting. Mastery of the air has been obtained by the British in this section, and it is seldom that a German plane is encountered except far over the enemy's territory.

One encounter yesterday, before Monchy, was so breathlessly dramatic that armies on the two sides, then battling in one of the fiercest encounters of the war, literally stopped a moment to watch the duel.

See Stars

Three miles up were the adversaries. They approached near each other by successive dashes from behind creamy, puffy clouds.

One of the birds was easily recog-

SHOT FROM GUN MOUNTED ON STEAMER MONGOLIA SENDS A U-BOAT TO OOZE AT BOTTOM OF OCEAN'S BARRED ZONE

LITIGATION CLOSES IN RAILROADS LAND CASE

WASHINGTON, April 25.—The supreme court today decided in favor of the government in the noted Oregon and California land case, involving millions of acres of land granted to railroads and claimed by the United States for forfeiture.

All the land included in the grant now reverts back to the government and will likely be opened for settlement under the homestead laws.

The case, causing 10 years of litigation between the government and railroads, grew out of valuable grants of land in Oregon and California to transcontinental railroads. The railroads were to sell the land to actual settlers for not more than \$250 an acre. Much of it was sold, contrary to the grant—and the government tried to have the land forfeited.

LONDON, April 25.—Captain Rice, of the American steamship Mongolia, which has arrived at a British port today reported that the Mongolia had fired the first gun of the war for the United States and sunk a German submarine.

The naval gunners on board made a clean hit at 1000 yards. The periscope was seen to be shattered.

Even more pertinent a fact as regards the ultimate fate of the submarine was that the shell disappeared immediately after the hit was made. The captain stated that a shell always ricochets in the water and can be seen again unless it finds the mark. Oil also was seen on the water after the submarine disappeared.

The Mongolia was going at full speed and was a long distance away when the spray and foam subsided, but from the bridge the officers observed the spot through their glasses and they are confident the submarine was sunk.

The submarine, Captain Rice said, was about to attack the great liner in British waters on April 19. He declared there was absolutely no doubt that the U-boat was hit and that there was every reason to believe it was destroyed.

The periscope was sighted dead ahead on the last afternoon of the voyage. The captain gave the order for full speed ahead with the intention of ramming the submarine.

The periscope disappeared and a few minutes later reappeared on the ship's broadside. The gunners fired, hitting the periscope squarely and throwing up a fountain of water.

Captain Rice paid a high tribute to the gunners and to the manner in which they were handled by their officer.

"For five days and nights," he said "I hadn't had my clothes off, and we kept a big force of lookouts on duty all the time. It was 5:20 o'clock in the afternoon of the 19th that we sighted the submarine. The officer commanding the gunners was with me on the bridge where, in fact, we had been the most of the time throughout the voyage."

"There was a haze over the sea at the time. We had just taken a sounding, for we were getting near shallow water and we were looking at the lead when the first mate cried: 'There's a submarine off the port bow.'"

"The submarine was close to us, too close, in fact, for her purposes, and she was submerging again in order to maneuver in a better position for torpedoing us when we sighted her. We saw the periscope go down and the swirl of the water."

"I quickly ordered the man at the wheel to pull it to starboard, and he swung the nose of the ship toward the spot where the submarine had been seen. We were going at full speed ahead, and two minutes after we first sighted the U-boat it emerged again about 1000 yards, its intention probably had been to catch us broadside on, but when it appeared we had the stern gun trained full on it."

"The lieutenant gave the command and the big gun boomed. We saw the periscope shattered and the shell and the submarine disappeared."

"I can't speak too highly of the cool manner in which the lieutenant handled his gunners. It was a fine exhibition of the efficiency of American naval men."

"We did not stop to reconnoiter after the incident, but steamed away at full speed, for it was not improbable that there was another submarine about. The one we got undoubtedly had been lying on the bottom at the spot waiting for the ship and came up when it heard our propellers."

"That's about all the story, excepting this: The gunners had named the guns on board the Mongolia, and the one which got the submarine was called Theodore Roosevelt; so Teddy fired the first gun of the war after all."

German Ships Throw Shells Into Dunkirk

PARIS April 25.—Dunkirk was bombarded by German destroyers early this morning. British and French patrol ships engaged the Germans, one of the French torpedo boats being sunk, according to an official announcement tonight.

The statement reads:

"A German destroyer flotilla bombarded Dunkirk between 2:15 and 2:25 this morning. The coast batteries replied and British and French patrol ships engaged the enemy, who retreated in the direction of Ostend at great speed. One of our torpedo boats was sunk in the brief action. The enemy's losses are not known."

Chicago Finds Self Suddenly On a War Diet

CHICAGO, April 25.—War-time food rations struck Chicago today. The management of a leading hotel announced a meatless day weekly beginning on Friday, while at the University club rules adopted eliminated all but six of the 17 varieties of bread formerly served and all expensive meats, and only one side order of vegetables is served with a meat order as compared to three or four formerly. Potatoes, formerly a side dish, have been made a straight order.

At a number of other clubs, hotels and cafes, including the Union League club, it was asserted that not only is a meatless day under consideration, but also a general curtailment of food.

OREGON CITY SENDING SONS TO ARMY AND NAVY

FIFTY-FOUR HAVE SIGNED UP FROM THE RANKS OF THE LOCAL MILLHANDS.

During the two weeks since Uncle Sam called for men for the navy and army, many from this city have responded, especially from the Crown Willamette Paper company and the Hawley Pulp & Paper company. From the Crown Willamette Paper company there were 28 enlistments, two in the aviation corps; three in the army and twenty-three in the navy. From the Hawley Pulp & Paper company twenty-six enlisted, two in the aviation corps; three in the army and twenty-one in the navy.

These men, who have enlisted, have been offered their position with the paper companies, if they desire them, upon their return to Oregon City.

Among the employees of the Crown Willamette Paper company, who have enlisted is Henry Lawler, age 21 years and son of Mr. and Mrs. R. E. Lawler, of Oregon City. He left for the training station at Goat Island a few days ago. Since his arrival at the naval training station, he is delighted with the new work before him, and says that all of the boys from Oregon City are in the best of spirits. Archie Haverstick, is also among the Oregon City boys stationed at Goat Island.

FOREIGNERS FILING Austrians, Englishman, and Italian Would be American Citizens

Three Austrians, one Englishman, and an Italian Saturday filed petitions declaring their intention to become citizens of the United States. They were: Amam Hodel, and Carl and Rudolph Bigge, all Austrians, of New Era; Andrew Lake, English; of Oregon City; and Frank Fulei, an Italian farmer, who lives near Milwaukie.

JOFFRE AND PARTY ARE GREETED BY OFFICIALS

WASHINGTON, April 25.—The tricolor of France takes its place today among the allied flags floating over the war capital of the world with the arrival of the French war commission.

The commission, headed by former Premier Viviani and Marshal Joffre, landed at the Washington navy yard pier from the president's yacht Mayflower shortly before 12:30 today.

Long before the scheduled hour of arrival, a crowd of men, women and children, which promised to be even larger and more enthusiastic than that which greeted Secretary Balfour and the British party at the union station Sunday, moved slowly toward the navy yard from all directions.

Many of the informal welcome-bore the tri-colors, the British emblem and the Stars and Stripes.

It's Joffre.

The crowd congregated gradually around the high fenced and heavily guarded yard, awaiting arrival of the Mayflower in her slip.

Most of the talk among the crowd here was of Marshal Joffre. He is the same "Papa" Joffre, the beloved of all poilus and of France.

It was the first time French warriors stepped on American soil for war work since the great French frigates helped at Yorktown.

With the French party are naval, military, aerial, munitions, shipping, grain and other experts, who will join in the world war conferences.

Few more impressive scenes have been witnessed in Washington than that enacted at the navy yard when the Mayflower arrived. Several thousand men, women and children lined the half mile lane from the navy yard gates to the pier where the yacht docked.

"Marsellaise!"

Mounted troopers came to attention from their position as guard of honor near the pier. Scores of naval and military officials were waiting to greet the French commissioners. After the Mayflower was warped into her pier, the marine band, on the lawn of the navy yard, struck up the "Marsellaise."

On the Mayflower's deck, standing out in sharp contrast among his civilian companions, was Marshal Joffre in red cap and pale blue cloak.

Immediately the gangplank was up. Secretary Lansing mounted and, as he stepped on deck, bugles sounded. All soldiers and sailors came to attention, as did the victor of the Marne, while the secretary of state hastened forward between the lines of the crew and greeted Viviani, Joffre and other members of the party.

Wooden Leg.

At Washington the party was met by Secretary Lansing, Counselor Polk, Assistant Secretary Phillip and Colonel Harte, President Wilson's personal aide, who boarded the yacht to extend America's official welcome.

Pathetically cheering among the group of Frenchmen stood Colonel Fabrey, Joffre's chief of staff, hobbling on the wooden leg he has worn since the German repulse at the gates of Paris.

BRITONS HONOR U. S.

LONDON, April 20.—America's partnership in the world war was celebrated by a religious service today in St. Paul's Cathedral, attended by the king and queen and other members of the royal family.

The Stars and Stripes floated from the highest tower of the parliament building at Westminster—the first time a foreign flag was ever displayed on that eminence—and flew above all government buildings.

The services in the historical cathedral, where the most momentous occasions of national rejoicing and mourning have been solemnized, was unprecedented in being the commemoration of the act of another nation.

Overhead in the dim arches hung the dust-weighted and battle-torn flags of famous British regiments, some of which had been carried in the American war of the revolution, while among the tombs and memorials of famous soldiers ranged about the walls were the names of those who fought against the colonies in that war.

The cathedral seats nearly 4,000 persons and was filled to its furthestmost recesses. All seats were occupied when King George and Queen Mary entered, followed by the Mayor and Aldermen of the 26 boroughs of London, wearing their scarlet robes of office.

The American embassy and consular staffs occupied front seats with representatives of the Pilgrims, the American society, the American Luncheon club and the American chamber of commerce. In the diplomatic section were officers in the uniforms of France, Russia, Italy, Belgium, Serbia, Montenegro, Roumania and Japan.

Throughout the cathedral the army khaki and the navy blue were conspicuous. In the reserved seats there were a large number of wounded officers and soldiers, including many Canadians and several Americans serving with the Dominion forces.